

From Webflow to a Custom Platform

We replaced a template-bound Webflow site with a purpose-built Next.js application and our own content platform — keeping full control of speed, search visibility, data, and cost.

WHAT CHANGED

Every row below is a **pain point we removed** on the left and the **capability we now own** on the right. Same content, same brand — a faster, more flexible, and fully owned foundation.

AREA	BEFORE — WEBFLOW	NOW — CUSTOM NEXT.JS + CMS
Performance	● Builder-generated markup with limited control over how pages render and load.	✓ Next.js server & static rendering with optimized images — fast, consistent Core Web Vitals.
SEO & discoverability	● Template-level SEO controls; little say over structured data and indexing.	✓ Per-page metadata, auto sitemaps, JSON-LD, instant IndexNow pings and AI-bot rules.
Content authoring	● Fixed field types and plan-capped CMS items; rigid editor workflow.	✓ Tailored content models with drafts, live preview, a publish checklist and scheduling.
Design & brand	● Constrained to the Webflow builder; designs bent to fit the tool.	✓ Figma-to-code on a shared design system — pixel-exact, no template ceiling.
Integrations & automation	● Limited backend logic; integrations stitched on as third-party bolt-ons.	✓ Built-in HubSpot, MS Teams, webhooks & analytics, managed from an editor dashboard.
Lead reliability	● Form submissions can be lost during a provider outage.	✓ Resilient lead pipeline with an automatic fallback queue — no lead lost.
Search	● Basic keyword search with no insight into what visitors look for.	✓ Full-text search (Meilisearch) with query analytics.
Security & compliance	● Platform-managed security with little room to harden or extend.	✓ CSP + Cloudflare WAF, rate limiting, bot protection and GDPR tooling.
Cost & ownership	● Per-seat and per-item fees, with content locked into the platform.	✓ Own the code and the data, self-hosted, with no per-item limits.

31

Pages rebuilt on the new platform

290+

Content items migrated across 11 collections

100%

Ownership of code & data — zero vendor lock-in

Auto

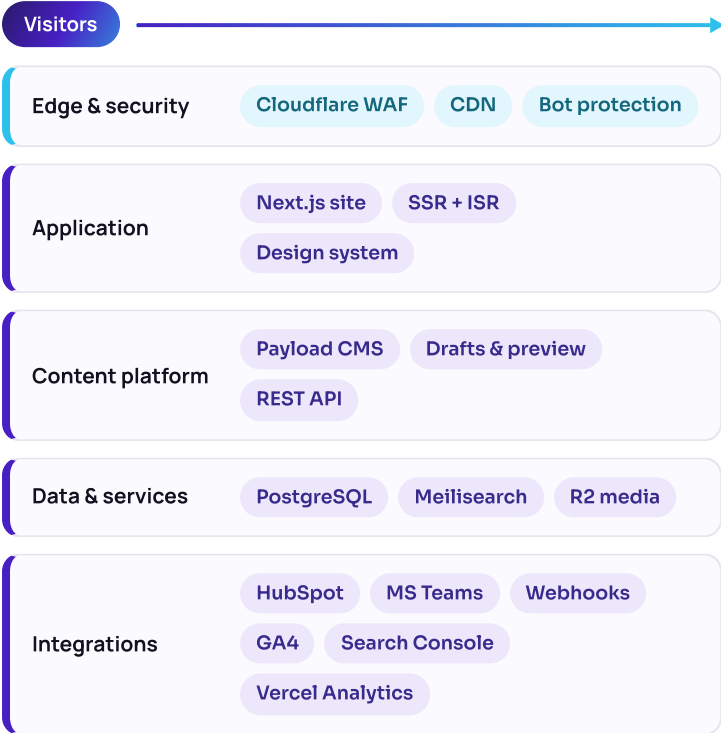
SEO: sitemaps · JSON-LD · IndexNow on publish

The result: a site that loads faster, ranks better, and adapts to the business — **without paying a platform for the privilege or losing control of the content.**

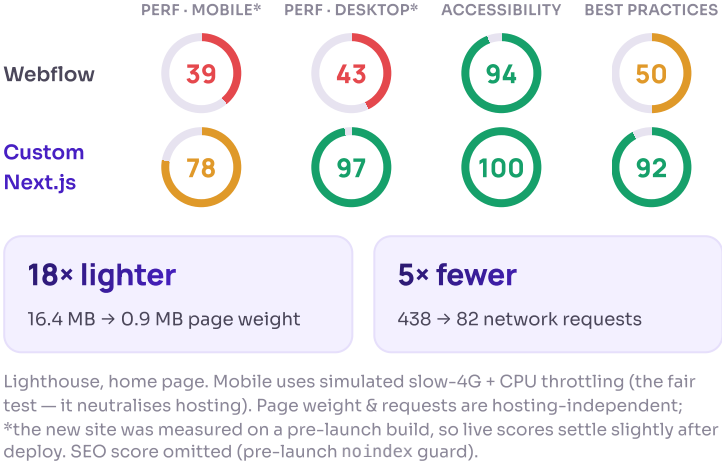
Under the hood – and how it compares

The platform we built, the content we moved, and a side-by-side look at where it pulls ahead of Webflow.

THE PLATFORM AT A GLANCE



LIGHTHOUSE – WEBFLOW VS CUSTOM NEXT.JS

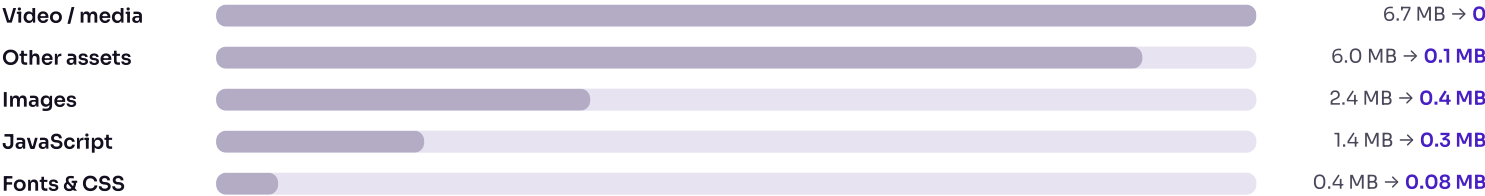


WEBFLOW VS CUSTOM NEXT.JS – FEATURE & COST COMPARISON

CAPABILITY	WEBFLOW	CUSTOM NEXT.JS	CAPABILITY	WEBFLOW	CUSTOM NEXT.JS
Unlimited content items	✗	✓	Lead fallback queue	✗	✓
Custom backend logic & APIs	✗	✓	Custom integrations & automation	~	✓
Drafts · preview · publish checklist	~	✓	Self-hosted · own the data	✗	✓
Full-text search + analytics	~	✓	No per-seat / per-item fees	✗	✓

✓ built-in ~ limited / partial ✗ not available.

WHERE THE WEIGHT COMES FROM



Webflow home page by resource type (bars); the rebuilt page after each arrow. 16.4 of Webflow's 16.8 MB loads from external third-party requests — the rebuild ships almost none, which is what keeps it light.

The gains above are **measured, not projected** — a dramatically lighter, faster, more accessible site, built on infrastructure you fully own.

What runs on autopilot

The work the platform does for you — across the CMS and the website — so the team ships content, not chores.

AUTOMATED END-TO-END

✓ Built in, not bolted on — **no third-party plugins, embeds, or add-on subscriptions anywhere.**

✓ On every publish

- Table of contents, reading time & word count computed
- Every change saved as a **version** — full history & one-click rollback
- Old URLs **auto-redirect** when a slug changes
- The team is notified in **Microsoft Teams**

☰ Leads & forms

- Every submission captured with a **fallback queue** — no lead lost
- Relayed to **HubSpot** CRM automatically
- Confirmation & internal emails sent (**Brevo**)
- Careers applications routed to HR with the résumé attached
- Spam & bots blocked at submit (Turnstile)

🖼 Images & media

- Uploads **auto-converted to WebP**; served as AVIF/WebP
- **Thumb / card / hero sizes** generated on upload
- Responsive, lazy-loaded & sized per device (next/image)
- **Focal-point smart-crop** for thumbnails & social cards
- Stored & delivered from the Cloudflare R2 CDN

✎ Authoring & formatting

- Rich editor: headings, lists, tables, callouts, code & embeds
- Pasted content **auto-cleaned** into consistent formatting
- Lists & spacing **normalised on save**
- Inline media with SEO-friendly, human-readable filenames

🔍 Search

- New & edited content **indexed instantly** (Meilisearch)
- Nightly drift check **self-heals** the index
- Search queries logged for content analytics

🌐 SEO & discoverability

- Per-page **titles, descriptions & canonical URLs**
- **Rich-result schema** — articles, FAQs, breadcrumbs, jobs (JSON-LD)
- **Open Graph / X cards** + auto-generated share images
- Sitemaps, **robots** & AI-bot rules generated
- Re-rendered on change (ISR) · instant **IndexNow** pings

🛡 Privacy & compliance

- Personal data **redacted on a retention schedule**
- Résumés deleted after the retention window
- **GDPR erasure** honoured across connected systems
- Cookie consent enforced (GA4 Consent Mode v2)

🔄 Reliability & monitoring

- Failed webhooks **retried automatically**
- Broken links scanned every night
- Errors tracked with personal data scrubbed (Sentry)
- **Nightly database backups**

ON A SCHEDULE — HANDS-OFF MAINTENANCE

• Every 5 minutes

Lead queue drain Webhook retry

• Every night

Search-log purge PII redaction Résumé purge
Broken-link scan Search reindex DB backup

Dozens of routine jobs — indexing, notifying, relaying, cleaning up, backing up — **happen on their own**, so the team spends its time on content and growth, not maintenance.